German Idealism Reading Group

Columbia University

Faculty Sponsor: Axel Honneth

Meetings: Thursdays, 2-4pm in 302 Philosophy Hall

Topic: Kant's *Critique of Pure Reason*.

Description: We'll work through Kant's *Critique of Pure Reason*, his magnum opus on epistemology and metaphysics. We will read the entirety of the B edition, the second edition of the *Critique of Pure Reason*. Topics discussed in this book include the a priori, a posteriori, mathematical knowledge, metaphysical knowledge, the limits of knowledge, space, time, intuition, the mind-dependence of the observable world, logic, concepts, judgment, categories, self-consciousness, schematism, imagination, perception, thinking, substance, causality, reciprocity, idealism, the phenomena-noumena distinction, ideas, the soul, cosmology, freedom, and God.

Schedule of Readings

Week **Reading(s)**

1 The Project of the Critique of Pure Reason
- "Preface" (Avii-Axxii): 99-105
- "Preface to the Second Edition" (Bvii-xliv): 106-124
- "Introduction" (B1-B30): 136-152

*Optional further readings:***
- Engstrom, "Understanding and Sensibility"
- Beiser, "Kant's intellectual development 1746-1781"

2 The Transcendental Aesthetic
- "Transcendental Aesthetic" (B33-B73): 172-192

Optional further readings:
- Warren, "Kant and the Apriority of Space"
- Shabel, "The Transcendental Aesthetic"
- Allais, "Kant's Arguments for Transcendental Idealism in the Transcendental Aesthetic"
- Allison, "Discursivity and Judgment" in *Kant's Transcendental Idealism*

3 Transcendental Logic & the Analytic of Concepts
- "Introduction: The Idea of a Transcendental Logic" (B74-B88): 193-200
- "Transcendental Analytic" (B89): 201
- "The Analytic of Concepts" (B90-91): 202-203

- "On the Clue to the Discovery of All Pure Concepts of the Understanding" (B91-B116): 204-218

Optional further readings:

- Longuenesse, "Kant on A Priori Concepts"
- Strawson, "Objectivity and Unity" (§1-2) in *The Bounds of Sense*

4 <u>The Transcendental Deduction</u>

- "On the Deduction of the Pure Concepts of the Understanding" (B116-B169): 219-226, 245-266

Optional further readings:

- Henrich, "The Proof-Structure of Kant's Transcendental Deduction"
- Engstrom, "The Transcendental Deduction and Skepticism"
- Allison, "The Transcendental Deduction" in *Kant's Transcendental Idealism*
- Allais, "Conceptualism and Nonconceptualism in Kant"

5 <u>The Analytic of Principles</u>

- "The Analytic of Principles" (B169-B175): 267-270
- "On the Schematism of the Pure Concepts of the Understanding" (B176-B187): 271-277
- "System of All Principles of Pure Understanding" (B187-B218): 278-295

Optional further readings:

- Allison, "The Schematism of the Understanding and the Power of Judgment" in *Kant's Transcendental Idealism*

6 <u>The Analogies</u>

- "System of All Principles of Pure Understanding" (B218-B274): 295-326

Optional further readings:

- Guyer, "Kant's Second Analogy"
- Strawson, "Permanence and Causality" in *The Bounds of Sense*

7 <u>Idealism & the Amphiboly</u>

- "System of All Principles of Pure Understanding" (B274-B294): 326-337
- "On the Ground of the Distinction of All Objects in General into Phenomena and Noumena" (B294-B315): 354-365
- "Apendix on the Amphiboly of the Concepts of Reflection" (B316-B349): 366-383

Optional further readings:

- Allison, "The Nonspatiality of Things in Themselves for Kant"
- Edmundts, "The Refutation of Idealism and the Distinction between Phenomena and Noumena"

8 <u>Transcendental Dialectic & the Paralogisms</u>

- "Transcendental Dialectic: Introduction" (B349-B366): 384-393
- "On the Concepts of Pure Reason" (B366-B396): 394-408
- "The Dialectical Inferences of Pure Reason" (B396-B398): 409-410
- "The Paralogisms of Pure Reason" (B399-B432): 411-415, 445-458

Optional further readings:

- Strawson, "The Logic of Illusion" in *The Bounds of Sense*

- Allison, "The Paralogisms" in *Kant's Transcendental Idealism*

9 The Antinomies

- "The Antinomy of Pure Reason" (B432-B453): 459-469
- "First Conflict of the Transcendental Ideas" (B454-B461): 470-475
- "Second Conflict of the Transcendental Ideas" (B462-B471): 476-483
- "Third Conflict of the Transcendental Ideas" (B472-B479): 484-489
- "Fourth Conflict of the Transcendental Ideas" (B480-B488): 490-495

Optional further readings:

- Allison, "The Antinomy of Pure Reason" in *Kant's Transcendental Idealism*
- Kohl, "Kant on Idealism, Freedom, and Standpoints"

10 Transcendental Idealist Solutions to the Antinomies

- "The Antinomy of Pure Reason", Sections 3-7 (B490-B535): 496-519

11 The Positive Uses of the Transcendental Ideas

- "The Antinomy of Pure Reason", Sections 8-9, with "Concluding Remark" (B536-B595): 530-550

12 The Transcendental Ideal & Proofs of God's Existence

- "The Ideal of Pure Reason", Sections 1-6 (B595-B658): 551-583

Optional further readings:

- Allison, "The Ideal of Pure Reason" in *Kant's Transcendental Idealism*

13 Critique of Theology & Appendix to the Transcendental Dialectic

- "The Ideal of Pure Reason", Section 7 (B658-B670): 583-589
- "Appendix to the Transcendental Dialectic" (B670-B732): 590-623

14 The Doctrine of Method 1

- "Transcendental Doctrine of Method: Introduction" (B735-B736): 627
- "The Discipline of Pure Reason", Intro and Sections 1-2 (B736-B797): 628-658

Optional further readings:

- Moore, "The Transcendental Doctrine of Method"
- Chance, "Kant and the Discipline of Reason"

15 The Doctrine of Method 2

- "The Discipline of Pure Reason", Sections 3-4 (B797-B822): 658-671
- "The Canon of Pure Reason" (B823-B859): 672-690
- "The Architectonic of Pure Reason" (B860-B879): 691-701
- "The History of Pure Reason" (B880-BB883): 702-704

Optional further readings:

- Chignell, "Knowledge, Discipline, System, Hope"

**Also generally recommended (full books on the First Critique):

1. Henry Allison, *Kant's Transcendental Idealism*

2. Beatrice Longuenesse, *Kant and the Capacity to Judge*.
3. Peter Strawson, *The Bounds of Sense*.
4. Martin Heidegger, *Kant and the Problem of Metaphysics*.

(I've noted when a selection in the optional readings comes from one of these.)